

REPORT TO THE PARLIAMENT OF THE FRENCH-SPEAKING COMMUNITY

IT projects for managing the careers of teaching staff

The Belgian Court of Audit audited the French-speaking Community's running of IT projects for managing the careers of teaching staff. It found that the IT system still lacked the maturity necessary to ensure proper payroll management. However, the overall failure of the projects undertaken since the early 2000s was offset by ad hoc solutions. These solutions helped, in particular, to streamline the flow of data needed for payroll calculations.

The Cepage project was launched in 2022 to modernise the IT management of teachers' careers and payroll. However, the public authorities did not include any cost assessment in this project. Estimates of 35.2 and 95.7 million euros were put forward but were not substantiated or updated.

The Court recommended assessing the obsolescence risk of the current payroll system, which was designed in the 1970s. The financial and operational sustainability of continuing to provide a free payroll service to the education authorities should also be evaluated. Furthermore, the Court recommended analysing whether using a single public service provider for the digitalisation of the Community's services still offers added value. Finally, the Court recommended analysing the difficulties recently encountered by large-scale IT projects at other levels of government before continuing the Cepage project.